

Chapter

Not a Wish, but Strong Willpower — Manifesting Goals the Right Way



Introduction: Merely Wanting Achieves Nothing

Today there is much talk of "manifestation" — want something in your mind, and you will get it. But in this short excerpt from a discourse, Acharya Upendra Ji gives a deeper warning: **even a light, fleeting wish is a karma, and it too bears fruit** — but often not in the way we imagined. A goal is realised through **prabal ichchha shakti** (strong willpower), not through a **passing thought**.

Karma Yoga — union through action; action that transforms a person from within. **Phalashruti** — the definite fruit of an action or a spiritual practice.

Seek, Don't Merely Wish

At the very outset, Acharya Ji makes clear the difference between "seeking" and "merely wanting":

**"'Seek and it shall be given' — that is said to the seeker.
'Wish and it shall be given to the wisher' — it is not
like that. It will not happen through wishes."**

**"They say, 'If wishes were horses, beggars would ride.'
It will not happen through a passing thought. 'Yes, I
am a king, I am a king' — nothing will come of that."**

A Passing Thought Is Also a Karma

Yet a fleeting wish does not go to waste either. A student of Karma Yoga must understand its reverse side too:

"What happens through such a passing thought — that also needs to be learned. **If you want to learn Karma Yoga, you should also know its negative outcome.**"

"If you say — it is not a strong desire, but there is a little desire — **then is that also a karma or not?**"

To explain this, Acharya Ji gives three examples.

First Example: "There Should Be Cars Ahead and Behind Me"

"'There should be cars ahead of me and behind me.'
What is the wish? There should be cars ahead of me and behind me. **But this is not a strong desire.**"

"Now its phalashruti will be that perhaps after some years, or in the next birth, **he may end up as a traffic constable on some very important, busy traffic signal.**"

The wish was fulfilled — there are cars ahead and behind — but in a form that teaches him how shallow that wish was:

"And then he will meet just such a car driver, someone who picks a fight. Or he sees the huge maintenance expense of a car, and he will say — **I don't want a car.**"

Second Example: A Dress Like the Heroine's

"There is some big film heroine, isn't there — 'I want to wear a dress like hers, do something like her.' **There is no strong willpower, only a wish.**"

"In the next birth she will become some heroine's washerwoman, **where she has to wash her designer dresses every day.** How much hardship there is in it, how much of a waste of time it is for her — only then will she learn this lesson, for sure."

"And then she will tell you — 'I don't want it now.' But she did make that wish, **its phalashruti has to come, it must come.** And the purpose that will come out of it is that the thought was not a serious thought."

Acharya Ji makes clear that the fault lies not in the object of the wish, but in its lack of seriousness:

"Now, is being a heroine a bad thing? Is having cars ahead and behind a bad thing? **But it was a passing thought, that is why the problem arises.**"

Third Example: A Fleeting Wish to Be a King

"Someone has no strong willpower to become a king, but a wish just came. Now he will be born somewhere — some big prime minister somewhere, **he will become a servant or a dog or something in his house, where he will see it all.**"

"He will be born in the house of just such a king who is very troubled, who is in tension, **so that nature will tell him, 'Don't you become a king.'**"

Why does nature do this? Because one who did not do his work properly at a smaller level and wants to reach the top directly could not make a good king anyway:

"Do you understand what nature is doing? The ideas he had in smaller times, he was not carrying them out properly; he wants to go up suddenly. **So such a man will not become a king anyway.**"

"That karma will take him over to such places. He will learn the lesson that this is not to be done — so that is good. **But in reality, the public should not get such a king.**"

Strong Willpower: The Path Opens by Itself

Now Acharya Ji shows the reverse side — where the wish is both pure and strong:

"But it can be the reverse — the good one, whose wish is good. **He will automatically reach such a king, or some such political party, where he will keep finding people who encourage him, and they will take him up, up, up.**"

"How can that happen? That wish will remain — **it happens through strong willpower.** It is possible. Then **he will keep finding just such a path, again and again and again.**"

So keeping a big goal is not wrong in itself:

"So if someone said, 'I want to become a heroine and nothing else,' there is no problem at all. **But if there is strong willpower, then such an agency will come or something.**"

Not Straight to the Summit: The Small Steps

But even strong willpower does not carry one to the summit in a single leap:

"But will a big blockbuster film come directly at the start? **That has not happened even for any superstar till today.** They too — they come up from small serials, don't they? **This many people forget.**"

Think Big — but While Erasing the Ego

Acharya Ji recalls a principle of Shri Vidya, along with a condition attached to it:

"**It is not bad to think big.** 'If you think, think big' — that is a statement of Shri Vidya. But before that big thinking, that series of smaller willpower — a lot of it will come in this."

"**Nature will test you many times.** One who has a very big vision, nature will bring down many times to do small tasks."

What is the purpose of these small tasks?

"Because a **Karma Yogi** has to look after other people a **great deal too**. All of it happens so that the ego inside him is wiped out. So this may fructify — in small ways."

One who has to do good for many must first see and understand everyone's life from below; and small tasks erase the ego within.

Karma Yoga Even in the Four Rotis at Home

Finally, Acharya Ji clarifies that he is speaking here of the Karma Yoga of a **great work** — but this does not mean there is no Karma Yoga in small, household tasks:

"The Karma Yoga of a great work — and what Karma Yoga is needed to make four rotis at home? That is fine, that is good, **one should become good for the home.**"

"I am talking about great work. But at home too one has to do well — **it is not that Karma Yoga does not happen there.** There is the small-scale kind too, that also exists."

Summary: Key Teachings

- 1 "Seek and it shall be given" — not "wish and it shall be given." Merely wanting, or repeating "I am a king," achieves nothing.
- 2 A passing thought is also a karma — its phalashruti must come, but often in the form of a hard lesson.
- 3 A fleeting wish for cars → a traffic constable at a busy signal; a wish for a heroine's dress → the heroine's washerwoman; a wish to be king → a servant in a troubled king's house. **Nature shows that the wish was not serious.**
- 4 The fault is not in the object of the wish — **being a heroine or a king is not a bad thing; the problem is the passing thought.**
- 5 **With strong willpower, the path keeps opening** — the right people and the right opportunities come together by themselves.
- 6 The summit is not reached directly — **even superstars come up from small serials.**

- 7 "If you think, think big" (Shri Vidya) — but nature tests one with a big vision through small tasks, so that **the ego is wiped out** and one can understand everyone's life.
- 8 **There is Karma Yoga even in small household tasks** — the small-scale kind is Karma Yoga too.